

Michelle Zhu

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OBJECTIVE

Designer turned quantitative thinker pursuing graduate study in Applied Statistics. I am dedicated to bridging analytical methods with creative thinking to make data more intuitive, human, and impactful.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley
Master of Statistics & Data Science

Expected Graduation: *May 2027*

San Jose State University
Bachelor of Fine Arts (BFA), Animation & Illustration
Minors: Mathematics & Statistics
Honors: Dean's Scholar (5 Semesters)

EXPERIENCE

Project: Post-Pandemic Recovery Analysis of San Francisco Cultural Institutions

- Cleaned and transformed real-world public datasets by converting data types, handling missing values, and preparing longitudinal data for statistical analysis
- Computed recovery metrics, including pre-pandemic baselines, pandemic attendance declines, and post-pandemic recovery ratios across five major cultural institutions
- Built an interrupted time series regression model to estimate pre-COVID trends, quantify the immediate impact of COVID, and evaluate post-pandemic recovery while controlling for institutional differences
- Created publication-quality visualizations in ggplot2 to communicate headcount trends and recovery patterns.
- Synthesized findings into a written report

Graphic Design Intern, SJSU Student Wellness Center

August 2023- August 2024

- Supported content creation for social media, event marketing, and the website by creating 20+ digital illustrations for seasonal health initiatives aligning with the Wellness Center's vision.
- Created 25+ sticker designs for mass print campaigns to address key wellness topics such as alcohol & drugs, nutrition, and safe sex for a variety of departments.
- Analyzed sticker design engagement data to inform reprints and future visual strategy.
- Interviewed department leads and students to optimize campaign messaging and design approach.

Graphic Designer, SJSU Shrunkenheadman Animation Club

May 2023- May 2024

- Designed and printed 35+ posters to advertise club events.

- Lead the design of a comprehensive branding package for a university art convention, including logos, mascots, posters, stickers, digital templates, and merchandise.
- Contributed to internal administrative tasks such as spreadsheets, presentations, and archives to plan and coordinate for a club with 500+ members.
- Distributed surveys to forecast merchandise sales and printing needs, compared vendor costs, and optimized design choices for budget constraints in order to balance aesthetic impact with quantifiable trade-offs in cost and production quality.

Teaching Assistant, Light and Optics

Fall 2022 & Fall 2023

Class summary: An investigation into the physical properties of light and optics relevant to the visualization of artwork for the screen arts industry.

- Assisted the professor in taking class notes, grading assignments, and mentoring students.

Corps Member, Americorps NCCC

Southwest Region | Nov 2020 – July 2021

- Completed 1,000+ hours of team-based national service across four U.S. states on projects in public health, economic opportunity, and youth education.
- Served as Service Learning Initiator, leading weekly team meetings, wellness check-ins, and community research to help my team understand local demographic needs and socio-economic contexts.
- Supported COVID-19 disaster response by coordinating high stakes operations at multiple rural and urban vaccination sites across Missouri that collectively administered 40,000+ vaccinations.
- Worked on economic opportunity and community revitalization initiatives through restoration of historic community buildings with the Southwest New Mexico Arts Culture and Tourism Organization.
- Assisted Arizona non-profit Pathways To Learning by developing outdoor, agricultural, and STEM-informed educational activities for underserved youth.
- Contributed to affordable housing construction for East African refugee families in Colorado through Habitat for Humanity, working within structured timelines, safety guidelines, and cross-functional teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Quantitative & Programming:** R, Python, SQL, Tableau, C, Excel, Google Sheets, dplyr, ggplot2, tidyr, data cleaning, Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), Linear Regression, Interrupted Time Series Analysis, Data Visualization, Statistical Modeling, Github
- **Tools & Visualization:** Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Acrobat, Premiere Pro), Blender, Maya, Zbrush, Canva
- **Workflow & Project Management:** Google Workspace (Docs, Slides, Drive), Trello, SyncSketch

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Native

- **Chinese (Mandarin):** Proficient